

F.No.6-3/2026-PMP.5
Government of India
Ministry of Education
Department of School Education & Literacy
PM POSHAN Division

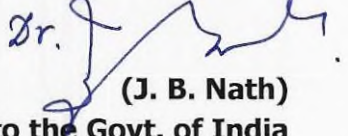
Kartavya Bhawan 2, New Delhi
Dated the 2nd June, 2026

Subject: Minutes of the Meeting of Programme Approval Board (PAB) held on 26.05.2026 to consider the Annual Work Plan and Budget (AWP&B) of State Government of Madhya Pradesh under PM POSHAN for 2026-27.

The meeting of Programme Approval Board-Pradhan Mantri Poshan Shakti Nirman (PAB-PM POSHAN) was held on 26.05.2026 through Video Conference under the Chairmanship of Shri Sanjay Kumar, Secretary, Department of School Education & Literacy (DoSE&L), Government of India, to consider the Annual Work Plan & Budget 2026-27 in respect of **State Government of Madhya Pradesh.**

2. The minutes of the above PAB meeting have been approved by the Secretary, Department of School Education & Literacy and the same are enclosed for information and necessary action.

Encl. As above.


(J. B. Nath)
Under Secretary to the Govt. of India

To,

1. Chief Secretary, State Government of Madhya Pradesh.
2. Additional Chief Secretary, Panchayat & Rural Development Department, State Government of Madhya Pradesh.
3. Secretary, Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment.
4. Secretary, Ministry of Tribal Affairs.
5. Secretary, D/o Drinking Water and Sanitation, Ministry of Jal Shakti.
6. Secretary, Ministry of Minority Affairs.
7. Secretary, Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disability, Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment.
8. Secretary, Ministry of Labour.

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9. Secretary, Ministry of Women and Child Development.
10. Secretary, Department of Food & Public Distribution.
11. Secretary, Ministry of Rural Development.
12. Secretary, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.
13. Shri Dheeraj Sahu, Additional Secretary (SS-II), MoE.
14. Ms. Archana Sharma Awasthi, Additional Secretary (SS-I & AE), MoE.
15. Director, NCERT.
16. Vice Chancellor, NIEPA.
17. Shri Asheesh Joshi, Joint Secretary (PMPY), MoE.
18. Dr. Amarpreet Duggal, Joint Secretary (Coord. & Media), MoE.
19. Ms. Prachi Pandey, Joint Secretary (Instt. & Training), MoE.
20. Shri Sanjog Kapoor, JS & FA, MoE.
21. Ms. A. Srija, Economic Advisor, MoE.
22. Joint Secretary, ICDS, Ministry of Women and Child Development.
23. Joint Secretary, Department of Food & Public Distribution.
24. Joint Secretary, Ministry of Rural Development.
25. Joint Secretary, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.
26. Dr. Sonia Pant, Programme Director (Education), NITI Aayog.
27. Dr. Pankaj KP Shreyaskar, DDG (Stats).

Copy also to:

1. PPS to Secretary (DoSE&L), Ministry of Education.
2. Shri Subandhu Basu, Deputy Secretary (Finance), DoSE&L, MoE.
3. Director (SS) / Director (KCM) / DS(RCM) / DS(PKS).
4. Under Secretary (KCM) / Under Secretary (RKS).
5. Shri Dinesh Pradhan, Senior Consultant, MoE for uploading the minutes on PM POSHAN website.
6. Guard File.

Government of India
Ministry of Education
Department of School Education & Literacy

Minutes of the meeting of Programme Approval Board to consider the Annual Work Plan & Budget (AWP&B) 2026-27 of PM POSHAN Scheme for the State of Madhya Pradesh.

The Programme Approval Board-PM POSHAN (PAB-PM POSHAN) meeting was held in virtual mode on 26.05.2026 under the chairmanship of Shri Sanjay Kumar, Secretary, Department of School Education & Literacy (DoSE&L), Government of India to consider the AWP&B for 2026-27 of Madhya Pradesh. The list of participants is enclosed at *Annexure-I*.

2. Shri Asheesh Joshi, Joint Secretary (PMPY), DoSE&L, Government of India, welcomed the Chairperson and other members of the Programme Approval Board and introduced the agenda for consideration.

3. The Board reviewed the State's key performance indicators under the PM POSHAN Scheme, as set out below, and discussed the implementation status across major operational areas.

S N	Indicator	Number
1	Total No. of Schools	87,492
2	Total Enrolment	58,80,038
3	PAB Approval	44,57,999
4	Average coverage of students	38,31,591 (65%)
5	Cook-cum-Helper engaged	1,96,179 (97%)
6	Cook-cum-Helper trained	1,28,364 (65%)
7	School Nutrition Gardens	58,580 (67%)
8	Health checkup	53,31,265 (91%)
9	Students received IFA	53,48,187 (91%)
10	Students received Deworming	52,81,930 (90%)
11	Schools having LPG	87,251 (99%)
12	Status of onboarding on SNA-SPARSH	No
13	Aadhaar authentication of students	56,13,282 (95%) 94% Biometric & 1% OTP
14	Avg. schools reporting on AMS	80,202 (91%)
15	Kitchen-cum-stores constructed	99,068 (96%)
16	Kitchen Devices procured	2,81,275 (97%)
17	No. of meals tested	1688 (report awaited)
18	Tithi Bhojan (No. of students)	32,27,933 (55%)

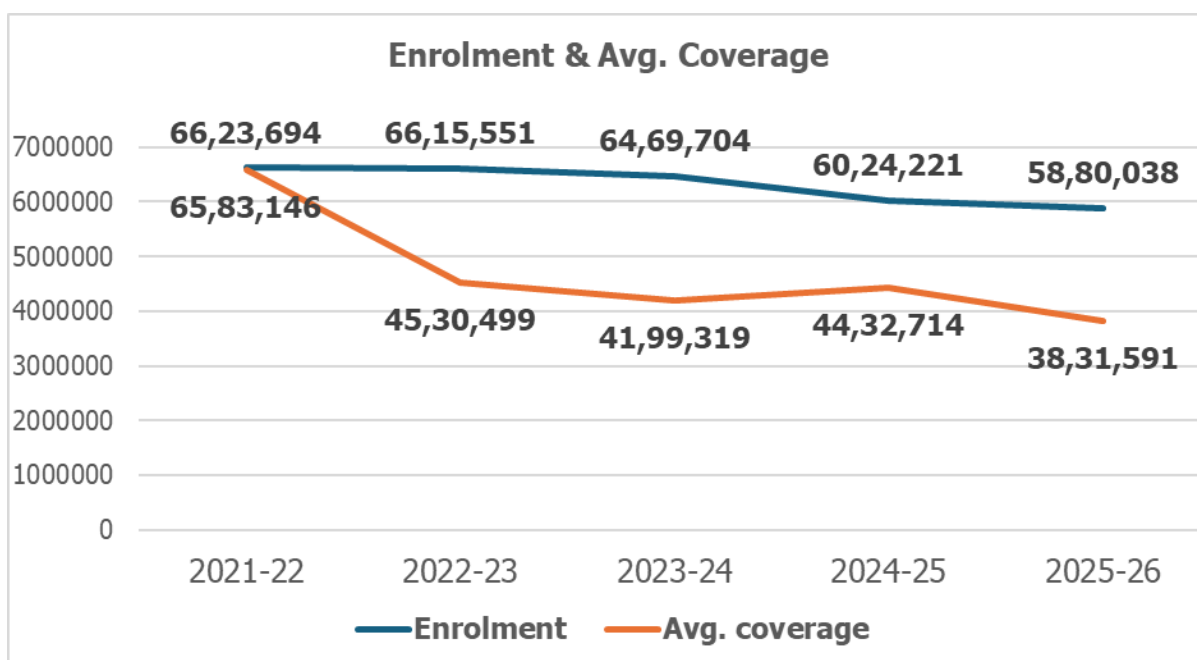
The PAB observed that the State's performance in components viz., coverage of students, training of Cook-cum-helpers, setting up of SNGs, health check-ups, provision of IFA and deworming medicines, onboarding on SNA SPARSH and provision of additional nutrition through Tithi bhojan etc. was not satisfactory. The State was advised to identify the reasons for the shortfall and take necessary corrective measures. The State was also advised to complete the Aadhaar authentication of students of remaining 5% and also update the data in MIS portal on monthly basis.

4. Change in Enrolment and coverage

Levels	Enrolment				Avg. coverage of students			
	2024-25	2025-26	Change	% change	2024-25	2025-26	Change	% change
Bal vatika	13,563	61,964	48,401	357%	9,726	32,548	22,822	235%
Primary	36,32,241	35,26,147	- 1,06,094	-3%	27,42,693	23,17,279	- 4,25,414	-16%
Up. Primary	23,78,417	22,91,927	-86,490	-4%	16,80,295	14,81,764	- 1,98,531	-12%
Total	60,24,221	58,80,038	- 1,44,183	-2%	44,32,714	38,31,591	- 6,01,123	-14%

The PAB appreciated the State over the increase in coverage of students in Bal Vatika. However, the PAB observed that the enrolment has decreased by about 2% (i.e. by about 1.44 lakh students) to 58.80 lakh in 2025-26 from 60.24 lakh in 2024-25. However, the subsequent decline in average coverage of students is very high with decline of about 14% (i.e. by about 6.01 lakh students) in 2025-26. The drop in average coverage is more evident in primary classes with reduction of 16% (i.e. by about 4.25 lakh student) from 2024-25. The PAB expressed serious concern over the fact that the decline in coverage is more than 4 times than that of decline in enrolment.

The PAB observed that the State Government has covered 65% of the enrolled students which is less than the National coverage. It was advised the State to ascertain the reasons for this drop in enrolment and particularly in average coverage and take corrective measures.



The PAB observed a continuous year-wise decline in student enrolment and average coverage during the last five years. Enrolment decreased from 66.23 lakh in 2021-22 to 58.80 lakh in 2025-26. However, the average coverage dropped sharply from 65.83 lakh in 2021-22 to 38.91 lakh in 2025-26.

The PAB expressed concern over the persistent declining trend in both enrolment and coverage. Further, as evident from the line graph, the gap between the enrolment & coverage is widening over the years which does not indicate a healthy trend and thereby may adversely affect the objectives of the Scheme of providing nutritional support to students. The PAB therefore, advised the State to select 10-20 schools in each district and undertake detailed analysis to identify the reasons for the decline, including migration, dropouts, demographic changes, lower attendance, reduction in Total Fertility Rate and transition of students to private institutions to improve enrolment, enhance student retention, and ensure that all eligible children are covered under the Scheme.

5. Issues

The following issues were also discussed during the meeting

S.N	Issue	Discussion / comment of PAB
1.	State is yet to on-board on SNA-SPARSH.	PAB advised the State to complete all the procedures for onboarding on SNA SPARSH by 5 th June 2026, for release of funds during FY 2026-27.

2.	Testing of meals not done in 6 districts (Agar, Damoh, Dindori, Seoni, Shivpuri, Sidhi).	The PAB observed that testing of meals was not done in 6 districts (Agar, Damoh, Dindori, Seoni, Shivpuri, Sidhi) during 2025-26. The PAB advised the State to increase the number of meals tested and continue to carry out regular testing of the samples of meals to check its quality and nutritional contents etc. across the State as envisaged in the Scheme guidelines. The State was also advised to share reports with the DoSE&L, MoE, GoI. The State was also advised to share the action taken note in case of samples failed to meet the norms.
3.	State has not initiated the Social Audit of FY 2025-26.	The State representative informed that the department has developed a Geofencing app for collecting online information for social audits. However, due to the delay in its development, the social audit could not be conducted on time. The PAB expressed deep concern that social audit was not initiated during FY 2025-26. Further, PAB advised the State to conduct Social Audit as per the scheme guidelines in at least 20 schools or 2% schools, whichever is higher in each district. State was also advised to draw annual calendar of activities to conduct Social Audit in a manner so that it is completed by September 2026. The State was also advised to share the Social Audit Report and action taken thereon after the completion of Social Audit.
4.	Low utilization of MME funds (only 74% against the annual allocation).	The PAB expressed concern over less utilisation of the MME funds and emphasised on the importance of monitoring and awareness generation for better implementation of the Scheme and advised the State to ensure full and optimal utilisation of the funds under the MME during FY 2026-27.
5.	State did not procure 8,426 units of kitchen devices sanctioned in FY 2024-25.	State representative informed that the central assistance towards procurement of 8,426 units of kitchen devices has been transferred in the account of School Management Committee (SMC) and the process of procurement has been initiated. The PAB expressed the concern over the issue as the procurement has been long pending. The PAB advised to complete the procurement of these kitchen devices by 30th June, 2026 and submit a report.

6.	SNG developed in 67% schools.	The PAB advised the State to make concerted efforts for the development of School Nutrition Gardens in remaining 33% schools in a time bound manner and involve students to give them a first-hand experience with nature. The produce of SNGs may be used in the preparation of meals under PM POSHAN.
7.	Training conducted for 65% cook-cum-helpers.	The PAB advised the State to organise training programmes for all the Cook-cum-Helpers during FY 2026-27.
8.	Only 55% students benefitted with Tithi Bhojan.	PAB advised the State to encourage community participation through Tithi Bhojan, to provide additional nutrition through meals/additional food items to students on regular intervals.
9.	Health checkup of students is 91%	The PAB observed that although the health check up has been carried out for 91% of the enrolled students however, the coverage was much below the state average in the districts of Dindori (44%), Agar(56%), Damoh (59%), Jhabua (67%), Datia and Morena (68%). The PAB expressed the concern over the less coverage in these districts and advised the State to prepare comprehensive schedule for conducting health check-up for all enrolled students under Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK) and to ensure proper follow-up and referrals, wherever required.
10.	In 12 districts coverage of students against enrolment is below 60%	The PAB observed that the coverage of students was less than the State average in 12 districts viz. Maihar (51%), Niwari (52%), Bhopal & Datia (56%), Ashoknagar (57%), Sheopur, Panna, Katni & Chhatarpur (58%), Shajapur, Sagar & Agar Malwa (59%) and suggested that the State may check the reasons for less coverage in these districts and submit an action taken report (ATR).

6. PAB Approvals

After detailed discussions PAB approved the following:

A. Physical approval

S. N	Component	PAB Approval
1	Students (Bal Vatika)	32,548
2	Students (Pry)	23,17,279
3	Students (U Pry)	14,81,764
	Total Students	38,31,591
4	Working Days	248
5	Cook-cum-Helpers	1,97,184
6	Construction of Kitchen-cum-Stores	4,366
7	Repair of Kitchen-cum-Stores	5,346
8	Replacement of Kitchen devices	1,177

B. Component wise approval of funds:

(Rs in crore)

S. N	Component	Central Share	Min. mandatory State Share	Total
1	Material cost	461.34	307.49	768.83
2	Honorarium to cook-cum-helpers	118.31	78.87	197.18
3	Cost of foodgrains: 113397.33 MT (Rice: 39,689.07 MT & Wheat: 73,708.26 MT)	26.65	0	26.65
4	Transportation assistance (Rs 1500 per MT)	17.01	0	17.01
5	MME	16.83	0	16.83
6	Construction of Kitchen-cum-Store	163.71	109.14	272.85
7	Repair of kitchen-cum-stores	3.21	2.14	5.35
8	Procurement of Kitchen Devices (Replacement)	0.83	0.55	1.38
Total		807.89#	498.19	1306.18
Admissible flexi component*		30.80	20.53	51.33

Includes tentative Unspent Balance (USB) of Rs 150 crore as on 31.3.2026 as reported by State. The final USB will be shared by the State via GFR 12-C format.

* No proposal has been submitted by State.

7. The computation of central assistance of Rs. 807.89 crore & 113397.33 MT food-grains and minimum mandatory State share of Rs. 498.19 crore has been done as per existing norms. However, it may be emphasised that the computation of the

Central Assistance of Rs 807.89 crore also includes tentative unspent balance of Rs 150 crore. (as reported by State)

8. The PAB also advised the State that, if it desires, it may add additional funds from their own resources.

9. It is clarified that the quantification of resources is only an estimate for release of Central Assistance and allocation of foodgrains during FY 2026-27 under the PM POSHAN Scheme. The National Food Security Act, 2013, Rules, Guidelines and Instructions issued under the PM POSHAN Scheme from time to time, provide that every child attending an eligible institution is to be covered under the Scheme and shall be served one hot cooked meal or provided with Food Security Allowance, as applicable, on all school days. During the year, if it is noticed by the State Government that more funds are needed to implement the Scheme, due to various reasons like increase in the attendance of students, increase in school working days or for any other reason, they may approach the Government of India, with justification, to seek additional Central Assistance and foodgrains. Similarly, if the Central Government observes a coverage lower than the approvals, the actual release may be restricted to the actual coverage.

10. The PAB advised the State to ensure uninterrupted supply of hot cooked meals to all eligible students on all school days as per the provisions in para 2.2 (v) of PM POSHAN Guidelines even in case of delay of release of funds, food-grains supply constraints or for any other reasons.

11. The State Government was further advised to follow Scheme guidelines for all components e.g. Provision of meals, engagement of cook-cum-helpers, Tithi Bhojan, School Nutrition Gardens, Testing of meals, Tasting of meals, Social Audit, Centralised kitchen, Training of Cook-cum-helpers, meetings of various committees at appropriate levels for monitoring purposes etc. in implementation of the Scheme. The State Government is also advised to disseminate the approvals of the resources to all the field functionaries in the State and districts to enable all the eligible institutions to ensure that every eligible student must be served hot cooked meal or provided with

Food Security Allowance on all school days irrespective of the approvals of PAB-PM POSHAN.

12. The Chairman thanked all the participants and the meeting ended with a vote of thanks to the Chair.



List of participants

1. Ms. Dipali Rastogi, Additional Chief Secretary, Panchayat & Rural Development Department, Govt. of Madhya Pradesh.
2. Shri Asheesh Joshi, Joint Secretary (PMPY), D/o SE&L, MoE, Govt. of India.
3. Shri Sanjog Kapoor, Joint Secretary & FA, D/o SE&L, MoE, Govt. of India.
4. Shri Sunil Sharma, Director, PM POSHAN, D/o SE&L, MoE, Govt. of India
5. Shri K. C. Meena, Director, PM POSHAN, D/o SE&L, MoE, Govt. of India
6. Shri Avi Prasad, State Coordinator, PM POSHAN, Govt. of Madhya Pradesh.
7. Shri Ramesh Chand Meena, Deputy Secretary, PM POSHAN, D/o SE&L
8. Shri Parveen Kumar Sachan, Deputy Secretary, PM POSHAN, D/o SE&L
9. Shri J. B. Nath, Under Secretary, PM POSHAN, D/o SE&L.
10. Shri K. C. Meena, Under Secretary, PM POSHAN, D/o SE&L
11. Shri Rajesh Kumar Singh, Under Secretary, PM POSHAN, D/o SE&L
12. Dr. Anindita Shukla, Principal Chief Consultant, TSG-PM POSHAN
13. Shri Bhupendra Kumar, Principal Chief Consultant, TSG-PM POSHAN
14. Shri Dinesh Pradhan, Senior Consultant, TSG-PM POSHAN
15. Shri Davander Kumar, Senior Consultant, TSG-PM POSHAN